

Project XTC

X-Touch Companion

The Unofficial Guide to the Behringer X-Touch, Bitwig Studio and DrivenByMoss

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Understanding how the X-Touch thinks.

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Chapter 1 - Meet the X-Touch

Why "Project XTC"?

XTC stands for **X-Touch Companion**. This guide is designed to sit alongside the official Behringer, Bitwig and DrivenByMoss documentation, bringing everything together into one practical handbook. If the name raises a knowing smile, that's perfectly fine - but throughout this book, **XTC** always means **X-Touch Companion**.

If you've bought a Behringer X-Touch, you've probably already discovered two things. First, it feels like a serious piece of studio equipment. Second, learning to use it effectively with Bitwig can be surprisingly difficult.

The Behringer manual explains the hardware. Bitwig explains the DAW. DrivenByMoss explains the extension. What has been missing is a guide that explains how all three work together. That is the purpose of Project XTC.

Who This Book Is For

This guide assumes you already know the basics of using a computer and Bitwig Studio. It does **not** assume any previous knowledge of MCU, MIDI protocols or control surfaces. Every important idea is introduced only when it becomes useful.

What the X-Touch Is

The X-Touch is a **hardware control surface**. It does not process audio or replace Bitwig. It provides tactile control over track selection, transport, mixing, **PLUG-IN**, automation and much more.

The Four Principles

1. Bitwig is in charge.
2. The selected track matters.
3. Modes change meanings.
4. Feedback is as important as input.

Before You Continue...

Don't worry about memorising every button yet. In the next chapter we'll take a guided tour of the X-Touch so every control has a name and a purpose before we start using it.

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Chapter 2 - A Tour of the Hardware

Before learning individual features, it's worth becoming familiar with the physical layout of the X-Touch. You don't need to memorise every control. The goal is simply to help you recognise where things are, so later chapters can refer to them naturally.

The Eight Channel Strips

The heart of the X-Touch consists of eight identical channel strips. Each strip includes a motor fader, a touch-sensitive V-Pot with an LED ring, a scribble strip display, and buttons such as **SELECT**, **SOLO**, **MUTE** and **REC**. Because every strip is identical, once you understand one, you understand them all.

The Master Section

To the right of the eight channels is the master section. It includes the master fader and additional navigation controls.

Assignment Buttons

The **TRACK**, **SEND**, **PAN**, **PLUG-IN**, **EQ** and **INSTRUMENT** buttons change what the V-Pots control.

GLOBAL VIEW

The **USER** button in GLOBAL VIEW opens Browser Mode when using DrivenByMoss.

Reality Check

If the number of buttons feels intimidating, remember that you rarely use them all at once.

Before You Continue...

The next chapter introduces the mental model that makes the X-Touch predictable.

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Chapter 3 - The Mental Model

Most difficulties people experience with the X-Touch come from thinking of it as a mixer with fixed controls. It isn't. The X-Touch is better understood as a window into Bitwig.

Bitwig Is Always in Charge

The X-Touch follows Bitwig's current state. If Bitwig changes, the controller reflects that change.

Selection Comes First

Before adjusting anything ask: **What is currently selected?** Successful workflows nearly always begin with **SELECT**.

Modes Change Meaning

The same controls perform different jobs in different contexts. Understanding modes is more important than memorising combinations.

Always Read the Feedback

Motor faders, LED rings and scribble strips constantly tell you what Bitwig is doing.

A Simple Workflow

SELECT -> Observe -> Adjust -> Listen

Notice that adjustment comes third, not first.

Reality Check

If the X-Touch behaves unexpectedly, check the selected track, current mode and scribble strips first.

Field Note

The best X-Touch users don't memorise hundreds of functions. They ask, "What is Bitwig telling me right now?"

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Chapter 4 - Banks and Channels

One of the first things to understand about the X-Touch is that it always provides **eight physical channel strips**, regardless of how many tracks exist in your Bitwig project.

If your project contains more than eight tracks, the X-Touch simply changes *which* eight tracks are currently under your control. This is where the ideas of **channels** and **banks** become important.

Channels

Each motor fader represents a **channel**.

In the simplest case:

X-Touch	Bitwig
Channel 1	Track 1
Channel 2	Track 2
Channel 3	Track 3
...	...
Channel 8	Track 8

If your project contains eight tracks or fewer, this relationship never changes.

The X-Touch behaves very much like a traditional hardware mixer.

Banks

Once your project grows beyond eight tracks, the controller cannot display every track at once.

Instead, it displays a **bank** of eight consecutive tracks.

The first bank contains:

- Tracks 1–8

The second bank contains:

- Tracks 9–16

The third bank contains:

- Tracks 17–24

and so on.

Changing bank simply changes which group of eight tracks is currently mapped onto the eight physical channel strips.

Field Note

The hardware never changes.

Only the relationship between the hardware and the Bitwig project changes.

BANK Buttons

The **BANK ■** and **BANK ■** buttons move one complete bank at a time.

For example, if you are currently controlling Tracks 1–8:

- Press ****BANK ■**** once.
- The scribble strips now display Tracks 9–16.
- The motor faders immediately move to the stored levels for those tracks.

Press **BANK ■** to return to the previous bank.

Watching the motor faders reposition themselves is one of the most satisfying demonstrations of what a motorised control surface can do.

CHANNEL Buttons

The **CHANNEL ■** and **CHANNEL ■** buttons work differently.

Instead of moving by eight tracks, they move by **one track**.

Imagine you are currently controlling:

Fader	Track
1	Track 1
2	Track 2
3	Track 3
4	Track 4
5	Track 5

Fader	Track
6	Track 6
7	Track 7
8	Track 8

Press **CHANNEL** ■ once.

Now the mapping becomes:

Fader	Track
1	Track 2
2	Track 3
3	Track 4
4	Track 5
5	Track 6
6	Track 7
7	Track 8
8	Track 9

Every channel shifts along by one track.

This makes it easy to bring a particular track into view without jumping an entire bank.

Reality Check

If a track seems to have "disappeared", it has probably moved outside the currently visible bank.

Use the BANK or CHANNEL buttons to bring it back into view.

Reading the Scribble Strips

Whenever you change bank or channel offset, the scribble strips update immediately.

Experienced users naturally glance at the displays before touching a fader.

This simple habit avoids accidental edits to the wrong track.

Why This Matters

Understanding banks and channels makes the rest of the X-Touch much easier to understand.

Whether you are controlling volume, sends, plug-ins or automation, the same principle always applies:

The X-Touch controls the tracks that are currently visible.

Everything else in the controller builds upon this idea.

Exercise

Create a Bitwig project containing at least twelve tracks.

Use the **BANK** ■ and **BANK** ■ buttons to move between the first and second banks.

Then experiment with the **CHANNEL** ■ button and watch how the scribble strips and motor faders update.

Pay particular attention to which track appears on Channel 1 after each movement.